

# Said Azaizah

MIT '30 • Course 6-14 (CS, Economics, Data Science) • Abu Ghosh, Jerusalem → Cambridge, MA  
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Arabic (native) • Hebrew (native) • English (fluent)

*An Optimist building tech where friction blocks human potential.*

## EDUCATION

### Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Fall 2026 – 2030

- B.S. in Computer Science, Economics, and Data Science (Course 6-14). DEAL FPOP alumnus, Martin Trust Center.

### MEET (Middle East Entrepreneurs of Tomorrow)

2021 – present

- Three-year selective program in partnership with MIT. Student '24 → LEAD '25 → Entrepreneurship TA → CS Instructor.
- Selected **15 of 130 alumni** for LEAD. Grade: Outstanding. 1st Place, Meta Competition Y1.

### Hebrew University Secondary School (Leyada)

2019 – 2025

- Israel's most selective school for gifted students. Only Arab student in cohort. Only US applicant in recent years.
- **Top 0.1% national rank**, 118.1/100 Technion weighted Bagrut average.

### Weizmann Institute of Science, Dual Enrollment

2022 – 2025

- Intensive Physics program at research level, Reisman Science Education Center.

## STARTUP & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

### Venture Partner, Contrary

Sep 2026 – present

\$288M AUM • Portfolio: Anduril, Ramp, DoorDash, Zepto, Replit

- Selected as one of **~25 undergraduate Venture Partners** across 40+ North American campuses to source early-stage founders.
- Sourcing high-potential founders across MIT and adjacent Cambridge/Boston ecosystems, with focus on the MEET / Palestinian-Israeli technical founder pipeline and MIT's Martin Trust Center inner ring.
- Provide diligence support and market perspective on prospective investments to Contrary's HQ investment team.

### Co-Founder & CTO, RoofMate

Jan 2024 – present

AppsFlyer Accelerator • 20 hr/wk

- Led an **11-person Israeli-Palestinian team** to ship the Android MVP: 500+ signups, 4 university partnerships, Haifa pilot planned.
- Architected bias-aware matching on MongoDB vector search and HuggingFace embeddings — interests and habits, not nationality.
- Founded as EmpowerED and pivoted through MEET Accelerator once validation showed roommate matching was the sharper problem. Revenue reinvested into a scholarship fund for Palestinian students.

### Team Lead, Shaman — 1st Place, HUJI AI Hackathon

2025

- Led concept and data logic for an assistant that reads government PDFs and fills forms in Arabic or Hebrew through chat.
- Learned React and TypeScript from scratch and won in **36 hours**; the hackathon was originally restricted to bachelor's holders.

## RESEARCH & ENGINEERING

### Lead Developer, Peptide Visual Lab (PVL)

Sep 2025 – present

Technion (Prof. Meytal Landau) / DESY-CSSB, Hamburg • 20 hr/wk, paid

- With zero biology background, learned the science from postdocs and shipped a working prototype in **two weeks**. Prof. Landau hired me on the spot.
- Built a web platform unifying multiple protein-structure predictors (TANGO, S4PRED) into one interface, replacing weeks of manual spreadsheet analysis with minutes of visual exploration.
- Adopted by **HIFIS (Helmholtz Association)** after multiple evaluation rounds and deployed on DESY's institutional Kubernetes cluster, saving \$600+/month against commercial cloud.
- Serving **50+ researchers across 4 labs**, saving ~30 lab-hours/week. Open-source and MIT-licensed, with two published PyPI packages; methods paper in preparation.

### DESY Delegate & Research Intern

Dec 2024 – Sep 2025

DESY / Weizmann Institute of Science

- Selected as **1 of 3 students in Israel**. Coursework in particle acceleration, relativity, and quantum mechanics. Assisted beam-diagnostics research and presented findings to DESY mentors and Weizmann faculty.

### Selected for Sharpies Elite Tech Talent Cohort

May 2025

- Declined placement to lead PVL development at the Technion full-time.

## TEACHING & LEADERSHIP

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### Orbit Ambassador, Class of 2030

Aug 2026 – present

*Martin Trust Center for MIT Entrepreneurship*

- Selected as Class of 2030 ambassador for **Orbit**, the Trust Center's platform for MIT student founders — now licensed beyond MIT to Bentley, TEX-E, and MIT Solve.
- Direct product-feedback relationship with Product Lead Doug Williams as Orbit consolidates into the Entrepreneurship Hub.

### CS Instructor, MEET

Jul 2025 – present

- Hand-selected by MEET's CEO from the TA cohort. Taught **120 binational students** across Y2 and Y3 in Flask, Firebase, and applied AI.
- Co-designed the **first fundamental redesign of MEET's Y2 curriculum since 2015** with the co-founder and CS lead, moving it from DHTML to AI systems: automation, agent design, infrastructure.
- Built MEET's enterprise automation platform — 10 plugins, 35 skills for instructor feedback and submission scoring — running at **\$75/month** against a \$5,600/year commercial equivalent.
- Built MEET's crowdfunding platform solo as technical product manager — **7,000+ users across 14 student startups**, shipped in 44 days, three languages with full RTL. React, TypeScript, Supabase, Cloudflare.

### ML Intern, BetterMind Labs

Jul 2025 – present

- Advanced to the 12-week Advanced Track: **top 9 of ~1,100 applicants**. Named among "top performing students."

### Math & CS Mentor, Leyada

2022 – 2025

- Established a peer-tutoring program pairing Arabic- and Hebrew-speaking students. Designed a story-strategy-solve framework that raised grades by up to 40%. The program still runs today.

## VOLUNTEERING

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### Community Recovery Volunteer

2023 – 2025

*Regional Farms & Retirement Homes* • 180+ hours

- Joined Jewish-Israeli friends volunteering after Oct 7. Excellence in Voluntary Commitment award.

### Cancer Database System

Feb 2026 – present

- Built a secure patient database for my uncle, a pulmonologist, tracking smoking-related respiratory malignancies and disease-progression correlations.

## ARTS

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### Lead Performer (Rawis / Soloist), Palestinian Dabka

2015 – present

- Elite 11-member Jerusalem troupe. Nine years, **42 original performances**. International festivals: Spain (2022), Budapest (2023, a 16-minute coexistence narrative). Led the troupe since 7th grade; performed at Jewish-Muslim weddings.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Languages:** Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, Java, HTML/CSS

**Frontend:** React, React Native, Next.js, Vite, Tailwind, Android Studio (Java/XML)

**Backend & Data:** FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, Firebase, Supabase, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite

**DevOps:** Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Rancher, Nginx, Caddy, Cloudflare, Vercel, Sentry

**ML:** HuggingFace (embeddings, transformers), PyTorch, S4PRED, TANGO

**AI-Augmented Development:** Designed a multi-terminal orchestration methodology with custom governance rules and automated quality hooks across three production codebases.

## LINKS & PORTFOLIO

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Portfolio [said-azaizah.vercel.app](https://said-azaizah.vercel.app)

GitHub [github.com/az-said](https://github.com/az-said)

LinkedIn [in/said-azaizah](https://in/said-azaizah)

PVL [peptide\\_prediction](https://peptide_prediction)

PVL docs [az-said.github.io](https://az-said.github.io)

Crowdfunding [meet-kickstarter.com](https://meet-kickstarter.com)

Shaman [HUJI\\_Hackathon](https://HUJI_Hackathon)

RoofMate [RoofMateExpoNight](https://RoofMateExpoNight)

MSSA [session-script-assistant](https://session-script-assistant)